sounds of exploding bombs and ricocheting bullets remain in their memories, often waking them up from sleep. Insomnia, stress and anxiety are the unsaid, unavoidable ghosts that stay even after the war has ended. Those who understand the value of the uniform of the Indian military and the responsibility that comes with it will continue to strive to earn it—for it offers a respectful life, a life full of adventure, a life less ordinary.

It has been more than two decades since I participated in the Kargil War, but its memories are still fresh in my mind. The lessons I learnt during that time have been the guiding beacons that help me take decisions even today. I understand the value of family better, I respect time more than before and I carry a sense of gratitude within me for every moment of my life I get to spend happily. Even though I have retired from the Indian Air Force, its ethos will forever remain in my heart. I was, I am and I will remain a flight lieutenant, the rank that is the most valuable thing I’ve earned in this lifetime.